

Can you keep up with the “red lady”? For the authentic three-card monte experience, you can enable the cheat feature, which causes the player to always lose, even if they select the correct card.

## The Program in Action

When you run *threecardmonte.py*, the output will look like this:

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Three-Card Monte, by Al Sweigart [al@inventwithpython.com](mailto:al@inventwithpython.com)

Find the red lady (the Queen of Hearts)! Keep an eye on how the cards move.

Here are the cards:

```
|J| |Q| |8|
|♦| |♥| |♣|
|_J| |_Q| |_8|
```

Press Enter when you are ready to begin...

swapping left and middle...

swapping right and middle...

swapping middle and left...

swapping right and left...

swapping left and middle...

--snip--

<screen clears>

Which card has the Queen of Hearts? (LEFT MIDDLE RIGHT)

> middle

```
|Q| |8| |J|
|♥| |♣| |♦|
|_Q| |_8| |_J|
```

You lost!

Thanks for playing, sucker!

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## How It Works

In this program, we use a (*rank*, *suit*) tuple to represent a playing card.

The rank is a string representing the card number, such as '2', '10', 'Q', or 'K', and the suit is a string of either a heart, club, spade, or diamond emoji.

Since you cannot enter the emoji character using your keyboard, we'll use the `chr()` function calls on lines 16 to 19 to produce them. The tuple ('9', '♦') represents the nine of diamonds.

Instead of printing these tuples directly, the `displayCards()` function on lines 28 to 43 interprets them and displays ASCII-art representations on the screen, like in Project 4, “Blackjack.” The `cards` argument for this function is a list of the playing card tuples, allowing multiple cards to be displayed in a row.